INCH-POUND

MIL-L-850E
7 June 1991
SUPERSEDING
MIL-L-850D
18 FEBRUARY 1964
(See 6.6)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

LIFE PRESERVER, YOKE TYPE WITH REPLACEMENT TYPE COVER

This specification is approved for use within the Naval Sea systems Command, Department of the Navy, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE .

1.1 Scope. This specification covers an assault type life preserver with buoyant foam pads. It provides 50 pounds (lbs) of buoyancy.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS.

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specification and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed *in* the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation *(see* 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, Naval Sea Systems Command, SEA 55Z3, Department of the Navy, Washington, D.C. 20362-5101 by using the self-addressed stamped Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 4220
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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-F-106	Fasteners, Slide, Interlocking
V-T-285	Polyester Thread
CCC-C-426	Cloth, Drill, Cotton
DDD-L-20	Label for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use)

MILITARY

MIL-C-496	Clips, End Strap (Ball Tips)
MIL-W-530	Webbing, Textile, Cotton, General Purpose, Natural or in Colors
MIL-R-3390	Rings, Dee
MIL-P-15280	Plastic Material, Unicellular (Sheets and Tubes)
MIL-G-16491	Grommet, Metallic, General Specification for
MIL-P-3454	Packaging and Packing of Life Preserver
DOD-E-699	Enamel, Exterior, Deck, Gray (Formula No. 20)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191	Textile Test Methods.
FED-STD-751	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government drawings. The following Government drawings form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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DRAWINGS

NAVAL SEA SYSTEMS COMMAND (NAVSEA)

803-969942 - Life Preserver, Yoke Type, Assembly and Details

2.2 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards) , the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Frst article When specified (see 6.2) , a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.4) .

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Drill - Drill shall conform to type 1, class 3 of CCC-C-26. The color shall be deck-gray, formula No. 20, Type I of DOD-E-699. The drill shall be vat dyed and shall show good fastness to light, salt water, laundering and crocking.

3.2.2 Inherently buoyant foam. The inherently buoyant foam shall conform to MIL-P-15280, LSC grade.

3.2.3 Webbing. Webbing shall be l-inch wide, equal in color and colorfastness to the cotton drill, and shall conform to type IIb of MIL-W-530.

3.2.4 Tie tape and reinforcing tape. The preserver tie tape and reinforcing tape shall be made from 1 l/8-inch cotton tape. The tape shall weigh not less than 0.18 ounce per linear yard and have a minimum breaking strength of 180 pounds. The color shall reasonably match that of the drill and shall show fair fastness to light, salt water, and crocking.

3.2.5 Metal hardware. Metal hardware shall be made from brass or corrosion-resisting steel and shall have a dull black "Military" finish. The spring of the collar and waist strap snap fasteners shall be made of phosphor bronze. Grommets shall conform to type 111, class 3, size 1 of MIL-G-16491. D-rings shall conform to class 1, symbol L, black oxide finish of MIL-R-3390. Ball tips shall conform to type 1, class 1, 1 inch, black oxide finish, of MIL-C-496.

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3 .2.6 Slide fasteners. Slide fasteners shall be polyester or nylon on polyester or nylon tape and conform to V-F-106 and shall be of type I, style 2, size LM, class A except that the tape width shall be 9/16 ± 1/32 inches. The length of the slide fasteners shall be 19 inches for the collar section and 19 inches for each of the body sections. All metal pieces shall be enameled and shall have perforated pull tabs. Color of the tape shall be deck gray, formula no. 20, type I of DOD-E-699.

3.3 Desgin. The life preserver shall consist essentially of an outside cover, a collar, a harness strap, metal hardware, and buoyant foam pads.

3.3.1 Outer preserver cover. The outer preserver cover shall be made from cotton drill (see 3.2.1) .

3.3.2 Collar. The collar shall be made from cotton drill (see 3.2.1).

3*3*3 Harness strap. The harness strap shall be made of l-inch cotton webbing (see 3.2.3) in accordance with the applicable drawings.

3*3.4 Inherently buoyant foam pads. There shall be one pad each side of front and one collar (or back) pad. These parts are cut to conform to Drawing no. 803-969942.

3.3.4.1 Buoyancy. The completed pads shall have the buoyancies specified in Table I when tested as specified in 4.6.4.

TABLE I - BUOYANCY OF COMPLETED PADS

	POUNDS
FRONT PAD	16.0 ± 12 oz. (per Pad)
COLLAR PAD	15.0 ± 0.5

3.3.5 Tape. The preserver tie tapes and reinforcing tape shall be of the width and length shown on the applicable drawings (see 3.2.4).

3.3.6 Metal hardware Metal hardware shall be in accordance with applicable drawins (see 3.2.5).

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3.3.7 Label. A label of bleached print cloth, conforming to type VI, class I of DDD-L-20, 2 ½ by 3 ½ inches, shall be sewn on the underside of the preserver as shown on the applicable drawing. The printing on the label shall be in waterproof black ink.

3.3.8 Stitching. All stitching shall be in accordance with FED-STD-751 as specified on drawing 803-969942. All stitching shall be done with type 2, class 1, size E polyester thread equal in color to the cotton drill and conforming in physical characters and color fastness to V-T-285.

3.4 Construction The manufacture and assembly of foam preservers shall conform to Drawing no. 803-969942 and sewing procedures.

SEWING PROCEDURES

(1) Cut fabric sections and drill sewing indications holes as per patterns.

COLLAR SECTION ASSEMBLY

"2) Place part 13 over part 12 at side (S-1) Sew back tack at drill hole and sew off at (P-1) open seam flat and sew zipper between drill holes D-1 along folded edges.

(3) Attach part 15 to part 12 and 13 at closed end of zipper opening using selvage as open edge. Turn under with 1/8 inch hem opposite selvage edge.

(4) Sew 1 part 14 to each front neck of part 11; Sew 1 part 14 to each front neck of part 10 using 1/4 inch seam to hold in place. Parts fit at locations P-2-3-4-5.

(5) Sew assembled parts 12 and 13 with zipper to part 11 around top and both sides starting at (P-2) and ending at (P-3).

(6) Sew part 10 to resulting assembly of above starting at (P-4) and ending at (P-5), leave assembly inside out.

(7) Using 1 by 4 inch cut webbing, fold over cut edge approximately l/4-inch and bar tack to seal raw edge of both parts.

(8) Install grommet in each finished piece of webbing l-inch center from bar tacked edge.

(9) Insert the 2 webbing parts to left side of collar side by side entered in opening with l-inch of webbing inside collar at (P-6) and (P-7) and sew in place. Turn collar inside out and Stitch 3 rows continuing around neck to form the top stitch.

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RIGHT FRONT SECTION

(10) Sew part 8 to top of part 2 at (P-8) and (P-9) ; Sew part 7 around edge of part 2 at the (4) drill holes D-2.
(11) Attach 1-1/8 by 13-1/2 inch tie tape to parts at drill hole D-3 with Box X tack. Tape is to be folded under 3/4 inch with edge down.
(12) Join 2 pieces part 4 at each end with a 3/4 inches back tack, 3/4 inches from fabric edge at (P-10) and (P-n) for zipper.
(13) Install zipper at opening in part 4.
(14) Place part 9 over termination of zipper opening to create guard over zipper assembly with selvage out.
(15) Attach 1 part 5 at S-2 to part 4 assembly at (P-12). Attach other part 5 at opposite end of part 4 assembly. Sew resulting assembly to parts 2 and 3 at (P-13) around assembly to (P-14).
(16) Fold top right front in 1 inch, slipping right bottom of collar into opening at top of right front, right front, approximately 1 inch; reinforce with 3 rows of stitching.
(17) Serge both ends of #30 neck webbing.
(18) Attach neck webbing to neck using 2 bar tacks at each end of collar opening just above edge.
(19) Hem part 6 at 9-inch dimension on one side only (P-15), fold in thirds according to drill holes D-4; top stitch this on three sides. Finished part is approximately 3 by 7 3/4-inches
(20) Drill holes for sockets 1-1/4 inches from end and 1 inch from finished side of part 6.
(21) Install studs and sockets as required.
(22) Sew part 8 to top of part 1 at (P-16) and (P-17) ; Sew part 7 around edge of part 1 at (4) drill holes D-5.
(23) Attach 1-1/8 by 13 1/2 inches tie tape to parts at drill hole D-6 with box X tack with tape folded 3/4 inch under with edge down.
(24) Sew printed label to part 3 at drill holes D-7.
(25) Sew part 6 placket to part 1 at top; start at (P-18) down to (P-16) and across face and up to (P-19).
(26) Join 2 pieces part 4 at each end with a 3/4 inch back tack, 3/4-inches from fabric edge at (P-10) and (P-n) for zipper.
(27) Install zipper at opening in part 4.
(28) Place part 9 over termination of zipper opening to create guard over zipper assembly with selvage edge out.
(29) Attach 1 part 5 at S-2 to part 4 assembly at (P-12). Attach other part 5 at opposite end of part 4 assembly. Sew resulting assembly to part 1 and 3 at (P-20) around assembly to (P-21).

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ATTACHING COLLAR TO RIGHT FRONT SECTION
REPEAT STEPS 16 THROUGH 18 OF LEFT' FRONT SECTION.

LEG STRAP AND FINAL ASSEMBLY

(19A) Assemble and lock shoulder snaps in place.

(30) Fold part 27 in half and place 3/4 by 1-1/2 inches box X tack approximately 1-1/4 inches from fold through both halves.

(31) Attach one end of right side assembly by using (2) 3/4 by 1-1/2 inches box X tacks at drill holes (D-7); When tacking be certain a small loop is allowed to form looseness in belt loop. Attach other end to left side assembly front using this same procedure.

(32) Drill holes in part 25 for studs and sockets using special fixture for location on webbing.

(33) Attach studs and sockets.

(34) Place 2 D-rings on belt until studs and sockets line up: lock in position with 3/4 by 7/8-inches box X tack allowing D-rings to have about 1/4 inch movement: Place 1 D-ring on opposite end; Fold webbing under to use a 3/4 by 7/8 inches box X tack through three thicknesses of webbing with a tight fit.

(35) Attach ball tip to end of strap next to stud assembly.

"36) Take part 26 and attach ball tip to one end.

(37) Install (2) grommets on ball tip end at 1 inches and 3 inches centers from end.

(38) Lace body strap through leg strap part 27 and attach with 3/4 by 7/8 inches box X tack 30 inches from center to end of body strap with balltip; lace part 25 to part 26 and place 1 D-ring on end of part 26 folding in raw edge of webbing and lock in position with 3/4 by 7/8 inches box X tack through 3 thicknesses allowing a tight fit. NOTE: Extra care must be taken on this operation to make certain all straps are in proper fashion and can not become twisted.

COVER IS NOW READY FOR FINAL INSPECTION
AND INSERTION OF FLOTATION FOAM PARTS.

(II) c. Release placket. RP-1; subassembly.

(1) Fold over cut edge (e) 1/2 inch, with the reverse side of the cloth in, and hem.

(2) Fold the piece thus formed, with the reverse side of the cloth in, so that the cut edge (e-1) coincides with a line (P) to (P-l).

(3) Again fold the piece, with the reverse side of the cloth in so that the fold formed in (2) coincides with the selvage edge (e-2).

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(4) Stitch a seam 1/8 inch from the edge around the entire periphery of the placket.
(5) On this semifinished piece attach two post studs (see drawing), stud bodies up, at points (P-3).
(6) At points (P-4) the socket and plate combinations are placed, plate sides up, and the socket parts in such a position that the dot marks are nearest the open end of the release placket when the assembly is attached to the left front part of the preserver.

(II) d. Release placket, webbing ; subassembly.

(1) A 6 1/2 inch piece of l-inch webbing is folded over on itself so that the cut ends coincide and stitched along either side 1/8 inch from the edge.
(2) A grommet is placed midway from either edge 1 1/2 inches from the folded end of the webbing. Two pieces are needed to complete the subassembly.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable or the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) First article inspection (see 4.3)
(b) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4)

4.3 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed on the submitted samples as specified in 4.3.1. First article inspection shall consist of the examination and tests of this specification (see 4.5 and 4.6). First article samples shall be forwarded to the Commander, David Taylor Naval Research Center, Attn: Code 2843, Annapolis, MD 21402. The samples shall be plainly identified by securely-attached durable tags marked with the following information:

(a) Samples for first article tests.
(b) Name of product, together with complete identifying information, such as manufacturers designation number.
(c) Name of manufacturer.
(d) Contract or order number.

4.3.1 Samples for first article inspection. The contractor shall submit the following samples representing normal reduction:

(a) Three complete life preservers
(b) Two square yards of each type of cloth used
(c) Three yards of each type of tape and webbing used
(d) Two complete sets of buoyant pads
(e) Two sets of all hardware used
(f) One cone of each type thread used
(g) Three sets of each length of slide fasteners.

4.4 Quality conformante inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall consist of the inspections and tests shown in Table II.

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TABLE II. QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION AND TESTS.

Inspection/Test	Requirement	Test	Sampling Plan Code Letter
Dimensions	3.3, 3.4 and drawing 803-969942	4.5	A
Visual	3.3, 3.4	4.5	A
Breaking strength of body straps	3.2.3	1/	C
Buoyancy	3.3.4.1	4.6.4	C
Operation of stud fasteners	3.3.6	4.6.2	B
Material	3.2	1/	1/

1/ Notes: Material certification or material test results shall be maintained to establish identity and traceability of materials used for each lot of life preservers.

4.4.1 Lot. For purposes of quality conformance inspection and test sampling, a lot is defined as all life preservers produced in one facility, using the same materials and production processes, and being offered for delivery at one time. Lot size shall not exceed 3,200 life preservers.

4.4.2 Sampling for quality conformance inspection. As a minimum, the contractor shall randomly select a sample quantity from each lot of completed life preservers in accordance with Tables 11 and III and inspect them in accordance with 4.5 and 4.6. Samples size depends on the sampling plan code letter shown in Table II. If one or more defects are found in any sample, the entire lot shall be rejected. The contractor has the option of screening 100 percent of the lot for the defective characteristic(s) or providing a new lot which shall be inspected in accordance with the sampling plan contained herein. The contractor shall maintain for a period of three years after contract completion, records of inspections, tests, and any resulting rejections.

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TABLE III. SAMPLE SIZE FOR QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTIONS AND TESTS

Lot size	SAMPLE SIZE Sampling Plan Code Letter A	Sampling Plan Code Letter B	Sampling Plan Code Letter C
2 to 8	All	5	2
9 to 15	All	5	2
16 to 25	20	5	3
26 to 50	20	5	5
51 to 90	20	7	5
91 to 150	20	11	6
151 to 280	20	13	7
281 to 500	47	16	9
501 to 1200	47	19	11
1201 to 3200	53	23	13

4.5 Visual and dimensional examination. Sample life preservers complete with body strap assemblies selected in accordance with 4.4.2 shall be thoroughly examined to determine conformance with the requirements of this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Table IV.

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TABLE IV. CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS.

CATEGORIES	DEFECTS
CRITICAL	
1	Components damaged, incorrect, missing, misfitting or faulty, impairing the function of the preserver as life saving equipment.
MAJOR	
101	Positioning of harness incorrect.
102	Stitching of cotton drill, webbing, and tapes non-conforming; not correct type stitch.
103	Slide fastener fly, slider protection patch, chafing patch, and safety tab (as applicable) not located as specified.
104	Dimensions not as specified on applicable drawings.
MINOR	
201	Completed preserver not clean; evidence of dirt or oil spots.
202	Improper tensioning in stitching ‘in parts other than harness.
203	Incorrect or illegible marking or both of preserver.

4.6 Test procedures.

4.6.1 General. All tests not herein described shall be in accordance with the methods specified in FED-STD-191; method 5660 shall be used for all light fastness tests.

4.6.2 Operation of post stud fasteners. The waist strap and collar post stud fasteners shall be opened and closed five times. The fasteners shall be capable of easy opening and positive closures.

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4.6.3 Slide fasteners. The slide fasteners in the collar section and each of the body sections shall be opened and closed five times. The fasteners shall be capable of easy opening and positive closing.

4.6.4 Buoyancy test. The completed front and collar pads, shall be individually subjected to buoyancy tests. In this test, the pad shall be placed in a cage of adequate size and sufficient weight to submerge the pad to show compliance with 3.3.4. This assembly shall be suspended from a direct reading scale, in fresh water, at room temperature, with the top of the cage 2 inches beneath the surface of the water. The scale reading shall be taken as soon as practicable, and the buoyancy calculated as the apparent weight of the cage and pad subtracted from the previously determined undewater weight of the assembly without the pad.

4.7 Materials testing. Material certifications or material tests results shall be maintained to establish identify and traceability of materials used for each component listed in 3.2.

4.8 Inspection of Packaging. Sample packages and packs, and the inspection of the preservation-packaging, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the requirements of section 5 and the documents specified therein.

5. PACKAGING

(The packaging requirements specified herein apply only for direct government acquisition.)

5.1 Life preservers shall be packaged by level A or C, packed by level A, B, or C, and marked in accordance with MIL-P-3454 as specified (see 6.2) .

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Life preservers made in accordance with this specification are used by pack-carrying troops in amphibious operations. It can be removed by one hand without affecting the back pack.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition Documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Issue of DoDISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of the individual document referenced (see 2.1).
(c) When first article is required (see 3.1)
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1).

6.3 First article When first article inspection is required, the contracting office should provide specific guidance to offerors whether the item(s) should be a preproduction sample, a first article sample, a first production item, a sample selected from the first 7 production items, a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory (see 3.1) , and the number of items to be tested as specified in 4.3. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results, and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has een previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract. Bidders should not submit alternate bids unless specifically requested to do so in the solicitation.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing) .

Buoyant
Collar
Outer Jacket
Slide Fastener
Vest

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6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Preparing activity:
Navy - SH
(Project 4220-0367)

Custodians:
Navy - SH
Army - ME

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INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-L-850E	7 June 1991

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
Life Preserver, Yoke Type With Replacement Type Cover

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
Commander Naval Sea Systems Command (SEA 55X24)	(1) Commercial (703) 602-0324	(2) AUTOVON (AV) 332-0324
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Washington, DC 20362-5101	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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